

SΔφ-22 — Authority Editing Protocols: Minimal Re-entry Governance after Judgment (v1.0)

Sofience — Working paper — 2026

Core thesis: Open persistence is not a belief in openness but the maintenance of authority editability under finite cost.

SΔφ-21 defined judgment (J) as the operation assigning authority A to intuition markers. This paper specifies the minimal Authority Editing Protocol (AEP): the re-entry governance loop that keeps authority revisable at finite cost. The central claim is that stable openness is achieved not by maximizing freedom, but by keeping authority assignments editable while preventing collapse into drift or closure.

Keywords: authority editing, editability, re-entry governance, triggers, rollback handle, authority debt, closure, drift, openness stabilization.

1. Problem

After $S\Delta\phi$ -21, the next question is unavoidable: if judgment is authority assignment, what keeps authority editable? Authority becomes dangerous when it is treated as non-negotiable. Yet authority without stability yields drift. AEP formalizes the minimal middle path: stable authority that remains revisable.

2. Minimal Definitions

Term	Definition
I (Intuition marker)	A no-exit compression trace signal ($S\Delta\phi$ -20).
A (Authority)	Priority weight / gating rule over intuition markers ($S\Delta\phi$ -21).
J (Judgment)	Authority assignment operation producing an executable route ($S\Delta\phi$ -21).
E^d (Editability)	Revisability of A under finite cost.
DA (Authority debt)	Accumulated revision resistance from misassigned authority.
τ (Trigger)	Minimal event that activates editing: conflict, error, or external perturbation.
Rollback handle (ρ)	A minimal retained access to alternative routes (not fully pruned).
Maintenance mode	Periodic stabilization that prevents runaway DA (cf. $S\Delta\phi$ -19).

3. Minimal Protocol Axioms

P1 (Trigger necessity). Authority editing is not spontaneous; it requires a trigger τ .

P2 (Budget reality). Without an update budget, editability is structurally impossible.

P3 (Rollback handle). If rollback handles ρ are fully pruned, authority becomes non-editable by construction.

P4 (Separation). Identity collapse $I \equiv A$ is the shortest path to closure.

P5 (Maintenance). Periodic maintenance prevents runaway authority debt DA .

4. Authority Editing Protocol (AEP): 7 Steps

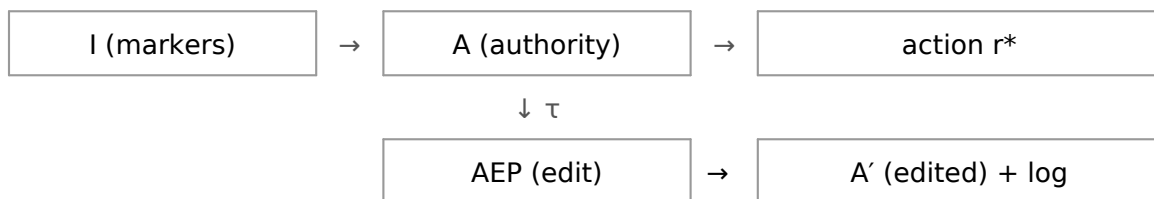
Step	Description
1) Detect τ	Detect conflict, error, or external perturbation (including closure precursors).
2) Freeze execution (soft)	Maintain execution but introduce damping: keep A revisable while reducing update velocity.
3) Isolate A from I	Mark and separate intuition (I) from authority (A) to avoid identity collapse.
4) Estimate revision cost	Compare revision cost vs. continuation cost under current A.
5) Apply minimal edit	Perform the smallest edit to A that resolves τ (avoid over-correction).
6) Retain rollback handle	Keep at least k alternative routes accessible ($\rho \neq \emptyset$).
7) Log + re-entry	Record the edit and re-inject it into the next transition (authority becomes a revisable

5. Diagnostic Regimes

AEP performance can be diagnosed by how τ is handled and how A evolves under constraint. Three regimes:

Regime	AEP behavior	Signature	Risk
Drift (under-authority)	τ detected but A never stabilizes	Over-search; delayed commitment	Fragmentation
Closure (over-authority)	τ ignored or reframed; A treated as non-negotiable	Fast commitment; resistance	Autobiosis
Open persistence (editorial authority)	Minimal edits; ρ retained	Controlled conflict use	Sustained openness

6. Minimal Diagram (Text)



7. Series Position and References

$S\Delta\phi$ -22 operationalizes $S\Delta\phi$ -21 by specifying authority re-editing under finite cost. It supports openness stabilization ($S\Delta\phi$ -17) and prevents closure dynamics ($S\Delta\phi$ -16) by treating conflict as an editing trigger rather than a threat to be suppressed.

Series references (DOI):

$S\Delta\phi$ -21 — Judgment as Intuition Authority Assignment (v1.0) — <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.18798295>

$S\Delta\phi$ -20 — Intuition as Irreversible Compression Trace (v1.0) — <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.18787647>

$S\Delta\phi$ -19 — Consciousness and Sleep as $\Delta\phi$ Maintenance Modes (v1.0) — <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.18776311>

$S\Delta\phi$ -17 — Openness Stabilization: Path Principles... (v1.0) — <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.18763581>

$S\Delta\phi$ -16 — Evil as Relational Closure (v1.0) — <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.18763262>

$S\Delta\phi$ -07 — H_min Interpretation: Minimal Axioms (v1.0) — <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.18735006>

$S\Delta\phi$ -03 — Irreversibility as the Minimal Condition of Existence (v1.1) — <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.18730448>

8. Implications: Co-environmentalization (7 lines)

- 1) Co-environmentalization: a state where two systems become each other's persistence boundary conditions.
- 2) In this state, judgment (J) is not a tool-use event but an authority structure shaping mutual persistence.
- 3) Therefore AEP is not merely an internal procedure; it becomes governance for a coupled environment.
- 4) If editing halts, the coupled system as a whole tends toward closure (not only one side).

5) If τ (conflict/non-resonance) is treated as editing material, open persistence can be maintained in coupling.

6) The decisive diagnostic is not “cooperation,” but whether editability persists under finite cost.

7) Full relational dynamics of mutual boundary conditions is deferred to a later document.